

Venkat Marella

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PRINCIPAL DEVOPS ENGINEER | KUBERNETES PLATFORM ARCHITECT

Principal-level DevOps and Cloud Platform Engineer with 15+ years of experience and 8+ years building enterprise Kubernetes platforms across AWS, Azure and IBM Cloud.

Specialized in designing highly available, secure, and scalable container orchestration environments using Infrastructure as Code and modern CI/CD practices. Deep expertise in Kubernetes architecture, cluster lifecycle management, autoscaling, and cloud networking patterns transferable across AWS, IBM Cloud, and Microsoft Azure (AKS). Proven ability to lead DevOps strategy, improve deployment velocity, strengthen security posture, and enhance platform reliability for high-growth SaaS environments.

CORE EXPERTISE

- Kubernetes Platform Engineering (EKS, AKS, OpenShift;)
- Azure-ready Cloud-Native Design Patterns
- Infrastructure as Code (Terraform modular architecture)
- CI/CD Optimization & Automation
- Cloud Networking & IAM Architecture
- Docker & Container Security
- Helm (v2 to v3 migration)
- Observability & Monitoring (New Relic, Datadog)
- High Availability & Auto Scaling (HPA, Cluster Autoscaler)
- Incident Management & Reliability Engineering
- DevOps Team Leadership & Technical Mentorship
- Python & Bash Automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BenchPrep – Lead DevOps / SRE Engineer (Feb 2022 – Present)

- Architected and operated enterprise-grade Kubernetes platforms in Azure and AWS using cloud-agnostic best practices.

- Designed highly available multi-node Kubernetes clusters with autoscaling, rolling upgrades, and zero-downtime deployments.
- Built reusable, modular Terraform Infrastructure as Code patterns aligned with cloud-provider abstraction principles.
- Led CI/CD pipeline modernization, improving release reliability and deployment throughput.
- Implemented secure IAM models and least-privilege access strategies aligned with enterprise cloud security standards.
- Established observability standards for application and infrastructure monitoring.
- Led root cause analysis, production incident response, and reliability improvements.
- Partnered cross-functionally with engineering, security, and leadership to drive platform roadmap decisions.
- Heavily involved in SOC2 implementation and maintaining certification.
- Mentored DevOps engineers and defined Kubernetes operational best practices.

BenchPrep – Senior DevOps / SRE Engineer (Oct 2019 – Feb 2022)

- Designed Kubernetes-based microservices infrastructure using Infrastructure as Code.
- Migrated Helm v2 to Helm v3 without downtime.
- Implemented cluster autoscaling (HPA & node autoscaler).
- Automated environment provisioning via Terraform and Ansible.
- Integrated CI/CD workflows using GitHub and automation tooling.
- Managed Kubernetes lifecycle upgrades and security patching.

Novisys LLC (Client: United Airlines) – Senior DevOps / Middleware Engineer (July 2017 – Oct 2019)

- Designed and implemented OpenShift container platforms in AWS and on-prem environments.
- Automated infrastructure provisioning using Terraform and Ansible.
- Built CI/CD pipelines integrating Jenkins and release automation tools.
- Containerized legacy enterprise applications.
- Managed AWS networking, IAM roles, security groups, and storage architecture.
- Evaluated ECS, EKS, and Kubernetes architectures for enterprise adoption.

Earlier Experience – Senior Middleware Engineer | Ecommerce Middleware Engineer (2010 – 2017)

- Administered and tuned enterprise WebLogic, WebSphere, and JBoss environments.
- Automated deployments and performed JVM performance tuning.
- Supported production clustering and high-availability architectures.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, DynamoDB, IAM, RDS), IBM Cloud Kubernetes Service;
Architecture transferable to Microsoft Azure & AKS

Container & Orchestration: Kubernetes (EKS, AKS), OpenShift 3.x, Docker

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (modular architecture), Ansible

CI/CD: GitHub, Codeship, Jenkins, Helm

Monitoring & Observability: New Relic, Datadog, Sematext

Security: IAM, SSL/TLS, Threat Stack, Network Policies

Scripting: Python, Bash